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EXECUTIVE PITCH BRIEF

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NextPatient

Staff Software Engineer: Legacy Integration & Platform Architecture (Ruby/Rails)

Target Role: Staff Software Engineer: Legacy Integration & Platform Architecture (Ruby/Rails)

Company: NextPatient

Comp Range: \$250,000: \$300,000 / yr (Remote, Full-time)

Tone Calibration: Understated, fact-dense, zero-fluff. Written for engineering leadership & technical screeners.

1. Mission & Architectural Alignment

NextPatient's mandate: **decoupling modern patient experiences (scheduling, check-in, waitlists, payments) from dated, legacy doctor's office EHR systems:** is a direct match for my 25+ year track record in **System Cartography, legacy subsystem decoupling, and zero-downtime platform safety.**

Why This Match Works (3 Grounded Signals):

1. **High-Consequence System Integration & Uptime Protection:** Extensive background in 4D System Cartography and operational risk modeling, mapping dark dependencies, lateral state mutations, and establishing release verification gates across deployment pipelines to protect mission-critical uptime.
2. **Strangler-Fig Decoupling & API Boundary Design:** At OneMain Financial, refactored high-volume financial customer acquisition flows spanning legacy database layers, multi-service Rails state machines, and third-party API supply chains: eliminating hidden lateral state mutations and cross-service blind spots.

3. **OpenTelemetry & Dark Telemetry Illumination:** Founded and technically led the enterprise OpenTelemetry initiative at OneMain, converting dark legacy microservice behavior into empirical telemetry and quantifiable risk governance.

2. Fit Matrix & Seniority Calibration

Dimension	NextPatient Expectation	Mike’s Grounded Evidence	Fit Evaluation
Legacy Integration	Plug modern SaaS into legacy EHRs without breaking live clinical operations.	Strangler-fig API decoupling across financial monoliths; zero-downtime data migrations.	🟢 Direct Match
Backend & Stack	Heavy Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, background jobs, zero-downtime migrations.	25+ years Ruby/Rails, PostgreSQL (including pgvector), Sidekiq/Redis, AWS/Kubernetes.	🟢 Core Stack Match
Platform Ownership	Staff IC leadership, responsibility realignment, developer velocity enablement.	Founded and technically led ACQ Enablement team at OneMain; led cross-team architecture reviews.	🟢 Staff/Principal IC Match
Culture & Alumni	High technical autonomy, async documentation, craftsmanship rigor.	Groupon alumnus; founded Software Craftsmanship McHenry County (820+ members); author of <i>Panoramic View</i> .	🟢 Cultural Parity

3. Proven Case Studies for NextPatient Leadership

1. **OneMain Financial Acquisition Lane Realignment (2021 to 2026):**
- *Challenge:* Implicit lateral state mutations across multi-step Rails state machines caused persistent data corruptions in high-volume loan acquisition flows.
 - *Action:* Refactored workflow state transitions, mapped seven acquisition channels, engineered an automated 5-phase PII deletion engine across 30+ tables, founded ACQ Enablement, and deployed enterprise OpenTelemetry tracing across microservice boundaries.
 - *Outcome:* Diagnosed and eliminated a persistent 4% silent traffic drop via DynamoDB session storage remediation, unblocked engineering streams, and built the Enterprise Trace.

- *Reference:* [case-studies/index.html#onemain-acquisition](https://just3ws.com/case-studies/index.html#onemain-acquisition)

2. SK Holdings & Real Estate Platform Modernization:

- *Challenge:* Monolithic Rails application experiencing search bottlenecks and Sidekiq background queue congestion under high transaction volume.
- *Action:* Upgraded core Rails versions with zero downtime, restructured relational database indexes, and modernized asynchronous worker queues.
- *Outcome:* Restored application throughput and reduced queue latency across search and transaction pipelines.
- *Reference:* [history/index.html#sk-holdings](https://just3ws.com/history/index.html#sk-holdings)

4. 30-Second Interview Calibration (The “Answer, Frame, and Pause” Rule)

“I specialize in strangler-fig modernization: connecting modern user interfaces and SaaS platforms to fragile legacy backends without disrupting live production operations. At OneMain Financial, I led the Acquisition architecture, mapping seven ingress channels, eliminating a 4% silent traffic drop via DynamoDB session remediation, and safely purging legacy PII across 30+ tables. NextPatient faces the classic challenge of modernizing clinical patient workflows against legacy EHR systems, and my background is built specifically to de-risk those integrations.”

(Pause & Hook): “I can dive deeper into how we decoupled multi-step Rails workflows, or we can look at how we safely migrated legacy database records. Which direction would you prefer to explore?”

5. Authoritative Verification Links

- **System Cartography Essay:** just3ws.com/2026/08/29/system-cartography-how-to-map-a-ten-year-old-monolith/
 - **Portfolio & Case Studies:** just3ws.com/case-studies/
 - **Canonical Résumé:** just3ws.com/resume
 - **GitHub Profile:** github.com/just3ws
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Direct Outreach & Referral Copy (Playbook)

[View Playbook Protocol →](#)

Pre-calibrated 75-word messages linking directly to this 1-page brief. Follows the *high-signal peer value* rule with zero calendar begging.

Cold Hiring Manager

Warm Peer / Referral

Subject: Principal Engineer note: Rails, distributed scale & platform res

Copy Text

Hi [Name],

I saw NextPatient is scaling Staff Software Engineer: Legacy Integration & Platform Architecture (Ruby/Rails) and looking for a Principal Software Engineer.

I specialize in high-consequence Ruby on Rails platforms and legacy modernization. Over the past several years, I served as Acquisition Lane Architect at OneMain Financial, decoupling lending funnels, eliminating a 4% silent transaction drop, and driving enterprise OpenTelemetry adoption across Rails and middleware tiers.

I put together a focused 1-page technical brief mapping my background to your current engineering challenges:

👉 <https://www.just3ws.com/exports/briefs/nextpatient-staff-software-engineer/>

If this aligns with what you need on the team, I would be glad to compare notes. If timing is off, no need to reply.

Best,

Mike Hall

<https://just3ws.com>